



Release Criteria Checklist - Open Government Canada

This form is a tool to ensure that an analysis of legal and policy requirements has been completed prior to the release of data to the public and internally. It also documents the approvals required for the release of the resource on open.canada.ca (Open Data, and Open Maps - OGP Open Government Portal available to the public) or Federal Geospatial Platform (FGP) only for spatial records, internal to GC.

Metadata/Resource Name	Description	Release Platform
NAFO Fishing Division 4T Herring Science Acoustic Survey 7c17f4eb-93fc-11ea-b1dd-f48c505b2a29	Since 1991, an annual fishery-independent acoustic survey of early fall (September-October) concentrations of Herring has been conducted in the southern Gulf of St. Lawrence (sGSL). The standard annual survey area occurs in the 4Tmno areas where both NAFO Div. 4T Herring spawning components aggregate in the fall. The survey uses a random stratified design of parallel transects within predefined strata. Surveys are conducted at night and use two vessels: an acoustic vessel to quantify the fish schools' biomass using a hull-mounted 120 KHz split-beam transducer, and a fishing vessel to sample aggregates of fish with a pelagic trawl (details in LeBlanc et al. 2015; see also LeBlanc and Dale 1996). Trawl samples are used to separate the estimated biomass by spawning component and age, determine species composition, and size distribution for the estimation of the target strength (LeBlanc and Dale 1996; LeBlanc et al. 2015). A standardized abundance index is generated from this acoustic survey. This index includes catch-at-age data since 1994. This survey also provides the age-disaggregated acoustic abundance index for ages 2 to 10 for spring spawners and fall spawners.	OGP

Release Criteria Checklist - Mandatory that all answers are YES to publish!

Legal / Licensing / Copyright

1. There are no known legal, licensing, or copyright restrictions to prevent the data or information from being released by the department or agency under the terms of the [Open Government Licence - Canada](#).

Authority to Release

2. Does DFO/CCG have the departmental mandate, legislative authority or permission from a third party provider to publish the data or information resource under the [Open Government Licence - Canada](#).

Access to Information and Privacy

3. Has the data/information been reviewed to ensure it is not subject to any exemptions or exclusions under the [Access to Information Act](#)?

4. Has the data/information been reviewed to ensure it does not contain any personal or confidential information? For further ATIP or privacy related guidance, please refer to the [Guidelines for the Informal Release of Information](#).

Security

5. Has the data/information to be released been reviewed and determined to be unclassified?

Note: Protected A, B, confidential, secret data/information cannot be posted on the Open Government Portal.

For further guidance on security categories, please refer to the following documents: [Information Security Guide](#) and the [TBS Directive on Security Management – Appendix J: Standard on Security Categorization](#).

Cost

5. Is the data/information being released without a fee to the public?

Format

7. Is the data/information provided in machine-readable/machine processable format?

8. Is the data/information provided in an open and non-proprietary format?

For further guidance on open and non-proprietary format, please refer to the [Standard on Web Accessibility](#).

Metadata

9. Is the metadata for the data/information consistent with the Government of Canada metadata standard? For further guidance on metadata, please refer to the [TBS Standard on Metadata](#).

Official Languages

10. Are the metadata and data both being provided in English and French as per the [Official Languages Act](#)?

Associated Publications

Is this dataset associated with a publication? If yes, please provide details:

LeBlanc, C.H., Mallet, A., Surette, T., and Swain, D.. 2015. [Assessment of the NAFO Division 4T southern Gulf of St. Lawrence Atlantic Herring \(*Clupea harengus*\) stocks in 2013](#). CSAS Research Document 2015/025.
LeBlanc, C., and Dale J.. 1996. [Distribution and acoustic backscatter of Herring in NAFO Divisions 4T and 4Vn, Sept. 23 - Oct. 08, 1995](#). CSAS Research Document 96/125.
Clay, A.; Claytor, R.R.. 1998. [Hydroacoustic calibration techniques used for southern Gulf of St. Lawrence herring fishing vessels - 1997](#). CSAS Research Document 1998/096.

I, Rachel DeJong, answer YES to all the above questions and hereby authorize the release of the above dataset and related metadata on the Government of Canada's [Open Government Portal](#), to be freely available under the terms and conditions of the [Open Government Licence – Canada](#).

Furthermore, I confirm that this dataset and any future updates, meet and will meet the mandatory Release Criteria Checklist outlined above.

NOTE: the remaining approvals must be completed in the Enterprise Data Hub.

Data Contributor:

Title:	Rachel DeJong, Aquatic Science Biologist	Digitally approved by Rachel DeJong on April 14, 2026, 1:55 p.m.
Sector:	Ecosystems & Oceans Science (Gulf)	

Data Steward:

Title:	Amélie Robichaud, Senior Program Officer / Administrateur de programme principal	Digitally approved by Amélie Robichaud on April 14, 2026, 3 p.m.
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